Brian Kim

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Education

PhD **University of California, Los Angeles**, Statistics — Los Angeles, CA
- Dissertation: Population Size Estimation using Multiple Respondent-Driven Samples

Sept 2012 – Oct 2017

BA **Amherst College**, Mathematics & Philosophy — Amherst, MA
- Graduated with Honors in Mathematics
- Thesis: Using Mode Identification Clustering Methods with Pitch F/X Data

Sept 2008 – June 2012

Research Interests

- Data Science Education; Social Network Analysis; Network Sampling Methods; Respondent-Driven Sampling; Population Size Estimation: Capture-Recapture and Multiple List methods; Social Science Applications of Machine Learning

Experience

Co-Director, Social Data Science Major — College Park, MD
College of Behavioral and Social Sciences (BSOS), University of Maryland — Sept 2021 – present, 5 years
- Led development of a new interdisciplinary major in Social Data Science and acted as the founding BSOS co-director, including managing the budget, setting up infrastructure, and working with partner units on campus.
- Developed and executed a program evaluation plan and delivered an annual learning outcomes assessment report, using R and Tableau to visualize and support findings.
- Served as chief data scientist for the ongoing campus-wide internal BEACON (Building Early Alerts for Campus Outreach Needs) project, which combined student data from the Registrar, Dean of Students Office, campus surveys, and learning management systems with machine learning to predict student outcomes, identify opportunities for intervention, and provide actionable insight for advisors.
- Oversaw computational infrastructure development for a cloud computing environment and continually manage and oversee the computing environment to support students.
- Managed a team of students and staff members to build a data repository hosting classroom-ready datasets and providing resources to support instructors; and launched the Data Curation Fellowship in which students identify, obtain, clean, and curate datasets.

Director of Graduate Studies — College Park, MD
Joint Program in Survey Methodology (JPSM), University of Maryland — Sept 2024 – present, 2 years
- Oversaw updates to the Master's in Survey and Data Science program, such as incorporating neural networks and LLMs into course material.
- Assisted graduate students in finding funding through grants or assistantship opportunities on campus.
- Chaired the Master's Admissions committee and coordinated with the Director of JPSM on recruitment efforts.

Associate Research Professor — College Park, MD
Social Data Science; Joint Program in Survey Methodology — Oct 2017 – present, 8 years 11 months
- Led research projects as PI or co-PI, writing and winning grant proposals and executing the research plan from start to finish; acted as analytic lead on collaborative research projects.
- Taught classes on introductory statistics, data science, machine learning, and programming for both undergraduate and graduate students, utilizing traditional and flipped classroom formats in online, in-person, and HyFlex modes.

Consultant/Facilitator Sept 2020 – Jan 2022
The Coleridge Initiative 1 year 5 months

- Provided guidance as a facilitator with the Applied Data Analytics program for teaching record linkage, text analysis, network analysis, and machine learning to working professionals in public policy.
- Consulted on NSF NCSES projects using Survey of Earned Doctorates, Survey of Doctorate Recipients, Higher Education Research and Development, and IPEDS data.
- Developed modularized lessons and notebooks for introductory statistics and programming in Python, R and SQL.

Statistical Consultant Los Angeles, CA
UCLA Institute for Digital Research and Education May 2014 – June 2016
2 years 2 months

- Assisted graduate students and professors in cleaning, merging, and preparing data for analysis using R, Python, Stata, SPSS, and other statistical software.
- Helped clients with their dissertations, publications, and other projects using methods such as mixed modeling, principal components analysis, simulation, and more.

Publications

Using a Stopping Rule to Optimize Cost-Quality Tradeoffs in a Large, Mixed-Mode Survey: A Simulation Study 2025
J. Wagner, B. West, **B. Kim**, D. Suolang, C. Engstrom, J. Sinibaldi
Journal of Official Statistics. 41 (1), 329-364
(www.doi.org/10.1177/0282423X241287452)

Hidden Population Size Estimation and Diagnostics Using Two Respondent-Driven Samples with Applications in Armenia 2023
B. Kim, L. G. Johnston, T. Grigoryan, A. Papoyan, S. Grigoryan, K. R. McLaughlin
Biometrical Journal, 00, 2200136
(www.doi.org/10.1002/bimj.202200136)

Using Geographical Data and Rolling Statistics for Diagnostics of Respondent-Driven Sampling 2022
B. Kim, M. Ogwal, E. Sande, H. Kiyingi, D. Serwadda, W. Hladik
Social Networks. 69, 74-83
(www.doi.org/10.1016/j.socnet.2020.05.001)

Population Size Estimation Using Multiple Respondent-Driven Sampling Surveys 2021
B. Kim, M. Handcock
Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology. 9(1), 94-120
(www.doi.org/10.1093/jssam/smz055)

Easy-to-Use Cloud Computing for Teaching Data Science 2020
B. Kim, G. Henke
Journal of Statistics Education. 29:sup1, S103-S111
(www.doi.org/10.1080/10691898.2020.1860726)

Partnering with a global platform to inform research and public policy making 2020
F. Kreuter, N. Barkay, A. Bilinski, A. Bradford, S. Chiu, R. Eliat, J. Fan, T. Galili, D. Haimovich, **B. Kim**, S. LaRocca, Y. Li, K. Morris, S. Presser, T. Sarig, J. A. Salomon, K. Stewart, E. A. Stuart, R. Tibshirani
Survey Research Methods, 14(2), 159-163
(www.doi.org/10.18148/srm/2020.v14i2.7761)

Software and Data

sspse: Estimating Hidden Population Size using Respondent Driven Sampling Data 2022
M. Handcock, K. Gile, **B. Kim**, K. McLaughlin
R package version 1.0.3, Los Angeles, CA.
(cran.r-project.org/package=sspse)

The University of Maryland social data science center global COVID-19 trends and impact survey, in partnership with Facebook 2020
J. Fan, Y. Li, K. Stewart, A. R. Kommareddy, A. Garcia, J. O'Brien, A. Bradford, X. Deng, S. Chiu, F. Kreuter, N. Barkay, A. Bilinski, **B. Kim**, T. Galili, D. Haimovich, S. LaRocca, S. Presser, K. Morris, J. Salomon, D. Vannette
University of Maryland
(covidmap.umd.edu/api.html)

Book Chapters and Non-Refereed Publications

The Value of Science: Special Theme 2022
J. Lane, **B. Kim**, F. Kreuter, A. Nunez
Harvard Data Science Review. Issue 4.2
(10.1162/99608f92.4a01213d)

Scaling Up Data Science for the Social Sciences 2021
B. Kim
Harvard Data Science Review. Issue 3.2
(10.1162/99608f92.d3f14ea4)

Workbooks 2021
B. Kim, C. Kern, J. Morgan, C. Hunter, A. Kumar
Big Data and Social Science, 2nd Edition. Chapman and Hall/CRC Press. 333-339
(textbook.coleridgeinitiative.org/chap-workbooks.html)

Selected Conference Presentations

A Hybrid Household and Respondent-Driven Sampling Strategy for Reaching Underrepresented Groups August 2023
B. Kim, A. Gard
Joint Statistical Meetings, Toronto, CA

Machine Learning Model Selection for Complex Sample Survey Data August 2020
B. Kim
Symposium on Data Science and Statistics

Data 8 Adoption at University of Maryland June 2020
B. Kim
National Workshop on Data Science Education, Berkeley, CA

Population Size Estimation Using Multiple Respondent-Driven Sampling Surveys August 2019
B. Kim, M. Handcock
Joint Statistical Meetings, Denver, CO

Teaching Data Science Using Jupyter Notebooks and Binder May 2019
B. Kim
Symposium on Data Science and Statistics, Bellevue, WA

Assessing Respondent-Driven Sampling Using Geographical Data November 2018
B. Kim, M. Ogwal, E. Sande, H. Kiyingi, D. Serwadda, W. Hladik
North American Social Network Conference, Washington, D.C.

Grants

Advancing Computational Expertise in Neuroscience and Psychology (co-PI) May 2025 – May 2026
UMD Artificial Intelligence Interdisciplinary Institute: Course Development Grant
- Funding: $10,000

Cloud-based Active Learning for BSOS Statistics and Data Science Courses (PI) Sept 2022 – Aug 2023
UMD Teaching and Learning Transformation Center: Experiential Learning Grant
- Funding: $135,573.72

An Evaluation of Sampling Methodologies for Reaching Underrepresented Groups (PI) June 2022 – May 2023
University of Maryland BSOS Dean's Research Initiative
- Funding: $19,999

Global Privacy Monitor (GPM): Learning from External Privacy Stakeholders June 2021 – May 2024
Facebook, Inc.
- Funding: $2,994,731

Modernizing NCSES Data Collection Approaches (co-PI) Sept 2020 – Aug 2021
National Science Foundation, NCSES BAA
- Funding: $88,802

Collaborative Research: Impacts of Hard/Soft Skills on STEM Workforce Trajectories (co-PI) May 2020 – May 2025
National Science Foundation, ECR: 1956114
- Funding: $401,716

Linked Dataset and Virtual Research Data Center (co-PI) Aug 2019 – Feb 2024
National Agricultural Statistics Service
- Funding: $653,490

Teaching Innovations Grant June 2020 – Aug 2020
University of Maryland
- Funding: $18,000

Teaching Innovations Grant June 2020 – Aug 2020
University of Maryland
- Funding: $5,000

Developing a New Course in Data Science: Introduction to Data Science for Social Sciences (PI) July 2019 – May 2020
UMD Year of Data Science
- Funding: $17,500

Feasibility Testing of a Respondent-Driven Sampling Approach to Recruit Human Trafficking Victims (co-PI) Dec 2018 – July 2019
Governor's Office of Crime Control and Prevention
- Funding: $30,000

Other Academic Work

Guest Editor 2022 – 2022
- Harvard Data Science Review, Special Theme: Value of Science. Issue 4.2.

Reviewer 2018 – present

- Journal of Statistics and Data Science Education
- Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology
- Journal of Statistical Software
- Public Opinion Quarterly
- Harvard Data Science Review
- Computational Statistics and Data Analysis
- Journal of Official Statistics

Teaching

Instructor (Undergraduate Courses) Oct 2017 – present

University of Maryland

- SDSB180: **Introduction to Data Management** (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- SDSB123: **Social Data Science: Pathways and Applications** (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- SDSB326: **Python Programming for Social Science** (Spring 2024)
- SDSB233: **Data Science for Social Sciences** (Fall 2019, Spring 2020, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023)
- INST 314: **Statistics for Information Science** (Fall 2018)
- INST 354: **Decision Making for Information Science** (Spring 2019)

Instructor (Graduate Courses) Oct 2017 – present

University of Maryland

- SURV 613: **Machine Learning for Social Sciences** (Fall 2020, Fall 2021, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026)
- SURV 622: **Fundamentals of Data Collection** (Spring 2020, Spring 2021, Spring 2022)
- SURV 673: **Introduction to Python & SQL** (Fall 2018, Spring 2019, Summer 2019, Fall 2019, Fall 2020, Summer 2020, Summer 2021)
- SURV 699M: **Review of Statistical Concepts** (Summer 2018, Summer 2019, Summer 2020, Summer 2021)
- SURV 701: **Analysis of Complex Sample Survey Data** (Spring 2021)
- SURV 727: **Fundamentals of Computing and Data Display** (Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025)
- SURV 736: **Introduction to Web Scraping with R** (Summer 2025)

Instructor Jan 2017 – Mar 2017

University of California, Los Angeles

- Stat 98T: **Six Degrees of Separation: Studying the World Through Social Networks** (Winter 2017)

Teaching Assistant Sept 2013 – June 2016

University of California, Los Angeles

- Stat 10: **Introduction to Statistical Reasoning** (Fall 2013, Winter 2014, Spring 2014, Fall 2014, Winter 2015, Spring 2015, Fall 2015, Winter 2016, Spring 2016)

Mentorship

Doctoral Students

Advisor

- Harold Gomes (expected 2026)

Doctoral Committee
Committee Member
- Yuting Chen, University of Maryland (2025)
- Ai Rene Ong, University of Michigan (2022)
- Jordan Epistola, University of Maryland (2022)

Graduate Students on Funded Projects
Supervisor
- Namit Shrivastava (January 2026 – May 2026)
- Ujjayini Das (September 2022 – August 2023)
- Joseph Hoskisson (September 2022 – August 2023)
- Franklin Yang (September 2021 – August 2022)
- Sofi Sinozich (September 2020 – August 2021)

Undergraduate Capstone Projects
Faculty Mentor
- Pragya Kumar, Orla Collins, Giulia Hoorens van Heyningen (2026) *Assessing the Viability of Weighting Methods for Hybrid Sampling Design*
- Danny Pham, Tariq Witherspoon, Andrew Shin (2026) *Machine Learning Model Selection with Complex Sample Survey Data*

Service

- Faculty Coordinator, Joint Program in Survey Methodology Short Course Program
- Co-Chair, Social Data Science Program Committee
- Co-Chair, Department of Psychology Lecturer Search Committee
- Chair, Social Data Science Curriculum Committee
- Chair, Search Committee for Executive Director of the Center for Advances in Data and Measurement
- Member/Chair, JPSM/MPSM Masters Admissions Committee
- Member, Department of Economics Lecturer Search Committee
- Member, Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice Lecturer Search Committee
- Member, College of Information Studies Lecturer Search Committee
- Member, Social Data Science Advisor Search Committee
- Member, Social Data Science Steering Committee
- Member, JPSM/MPSM Teaching Assignment Committee

Skills

Statistical Software
Highly skilled in R, SQL and Python, including various packages such as Rcpp, shiny, caret, tidyverse, tidymodels, parallel, snow, and more (in R); pandas, scikit-learn, nltk, tensorflow, keras, and more (in Python); Tableau

Statistics
Highly skilled in a variety of methods, including but not limited to hypothesis testing, regression, mixed models, clustering analysis, social network analysis, social network models, network sampling methods, Monte Carlo simulation, Bayesian models, machine learning, natural language processing, web scraping, neural networks, parallel computing, and more.

Other Software
Skilled or proficient in the use of many other programs, including, but not limited to, Microsoft Word, Excel and Powerpoint; LaTeX.